Maude Barlow



Born in Toronto, Canada, in 1947, Maude Barlow is an activist and water policy critic. She is the author or coauthor of 18 books, including the bestseller *Blue Gold: The Fight to Stop the Corporate Theft of the World's Water*. Barlow formerly served as an adviser on water to the United Nations, and led moves to have water recognized as a basic human right. In 2012, she helped found the Blue Planet Project, which campaigns for the right to water. Barlow chairs the Council of Canadians social action group, and was one of the "1000 Women for Peace" nominated for the 2005 Nobel Peace Prize. In 2008, she received the Citation of Lifetime Achievement, Canada's highest honor for environmentalism.

Key works

2002 *Blue Gold: The Fight to Stop the Corporate Theft of the World's Water*

2007 *Blue Covenant: The Global Water Crisis and the Coming Battle for the Right to Water*

2014 *Blue Future: Protecting Water for People and the Planet Forever*

Increased demand

Human use of freshwater has increased six-fold since about 1900, and demand has been increasing at about 1 percent per year since the 1980s—due in part to population growth. The rise in demand has also been driven